

ZACHOS

USER GUIDE

A gaming & streaming desktop, ready out of the box.
This guide walks through everything you'll actually use.

1. Welcome

ZachOS is a ready-to-go desktop for gaming and content creation. Steam, OBS, graphics drivers for AMD/Intel/Nvidia, and a full performance overlay are already installed and working - there's nothing to set up before you can play or start recording.

Everything ZachOS-specific lives in one app: **Zach Center**. It's on the taskbar and in the app launcher. The rest of this guide is basically a tour of its five tabs, plus a few keyboard shortcuts worth knowing.

2. The Desktop

The bar along the bottom of the screen is the only thing you really need to know:

Launcher (far left)	opens the app menu - everything installed lives here.
Pinned apps	Files, Firefox, a terminal, Steam, and Zach Center, one click away.
System tray (right side)	volume, network, and display icons.
Clock (far right)	date and time.

3. Zach Center - Your Control Panel

Open it from the taskbar, or run zach-center in a terminal. It has five tabs:

Overlay

The in-game performance overlay - FPS, CPU/GPU load, temperatures, and more, shown over the top of any game. Works like MSI Afterburner + RivaTuner, but built in.

- **Shift (right) + F12** - show or hide the overlay
- **Shift (right) + F10** - switch to the next level
- Pick which level a game starts on, or turn it off entirely
- Add, duplicate, rename or delete levels - choose exactly what's shown, where it sits on screen, the font size, and the colors

Changes apply instantly, even while a game is already running - no restart needed.

Apps

ZachOS ships lean on purpose. Anything else - Discord, Lutris, Bottles, Blender, VLC, and more - is one click away here, or search all of Flathub directly from the search box. Apps install for your account only, need no password, and only update when you tell them to.

Updates

Nothing updates on its own. No surprise restarts, no background downloads. When you want to update, press **“Update everything now”** - a driver restore point is saved automatically first, just in case.

Drivers

Shows your graphics card and the driver currently in use. If a driver update ever causes a problem, **“One-click driver rollback”** restores the versions you had before your last update. You can also “hold” drivers so future updates skip them.

System

Basic info about the install, and - only when running from the USB/ISO - the **“Install ZachOS to disk”** button (see section 5).

4. Command Line, If You Prefer

Everything in Zach Center is also a terminal command:

zach-center	open the app
zach-overlay list	list overlay levels
zach-overlay level 3	switch to level 3 (0 = off)
zach-overlay next	cycle to the next level
zach-update check	see what's available, installs nothing
zach-update apply	update everything (asks for your password)
sudo pacman -Syu	the plain Arch way to update, if you'd rather
zach-driver-rollback --previous	undo the last driver update

5. Installing ZachOS to a Real Drive

Booting the USB/ISO gives you a fully working test drive - nothing is saved when you restart. To make it permanent:

- 1 Open **Zach Center** → **System** and click **“Install ZachOS to disk.”** This opens a terminal and walks you through it.
- 2 Pick the disk to install to. **Everything on it will be erased** - double check you've chosen the right one.
- 3 Type ERASE to confirm, then set a hostname, username, and password.

- 4 Wait for it to finish installing (this takes a while - it's downloading and setting up the whole system).
- 5 When it says it's done, remove the USB and restart.

The installed system asks for your password to log in and to run anything as administrator - unlike the test USB, which skips both for convenience.

6. Gaming & Streaming

- **Steam** is already installed and on the taskbar - sign in and play. Proton (for Windows games) works out of the box.
- **OBS Studio** is installed for recording or streaming.
- The performance overlay (section 3) works automatically with any game - nothing to configure per-game.
- Need something not already installed? Check the **Apps** tab first, or search Flathub directly from there.

7. Good to Know

- Nothing updates, installs, or restarts without you asking it to. That's the whole point of the Updates tab.
- A driver restore point is saved automatically before every update, so a bad driver is always one click away from being undone.
- Apps from the Apps tab are sandboxed - they can't affect the base system, and removing one is as clean as installing it.
- If something ever looks wrong, open a terminal (Konsole, on the taskbar) and run the app by name to see what it prints - that's almost always the fastest way to figure out what happened.